

# Citation Integrity Audit

**Research Paper:** Error Propagation in Multi-Step Agentic AI Workflows for Research Automation

**Source reviewed:** research\_paper.pdf, 15 pages.

## 1. Executive Summary

The submitted paper contains **10 distinct bibliography entries**. Each entry was matched to an identifiable scholarly paper or official publication record. No fabricated paper title was identified. The main integrity issue is citation completeness: the paper body explicitly uses only citation numbers [1], [2], and [3], while references 4–10 appear in the bibliography without an explicit in-text citation. The bibliography also has some inconsistent venue/identifier details. These issues should be corrected before final submission.

## 2. Audit Summary

| Audit item                                | Result                                               |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Distinct bibliography entries             | 10                                                   |
| Citation numbers explicitly used in body  | [1], [2], [3]                                        |
| Bibliography entries not explicitly cited | References 4–10                                      |
| Fabricated references detected            | None identified                                      |
| Source existence                          | All 10 entries matched identifiable records          |
| Claim-support verification                | Needs claim-level review for every substantive claim |
| Metadata consistency                      | Minor corrections recommended                        |

## 3. Reference-by-Reference Verification

| Ref. | Paper                                                                                                             | Status                               | Record                         |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 1    | ReAct: Synergizing Reasoning and Acting in Language Models                                                        | Verified                             | ICLR 2023; arXiv:2210.03629    |
| 2    | Reflexion: Language Agents with Verbal Reinforcement Learning                                                     | Verified                             | NeurIPS 2023; arXiv:2303.11366 |
| 3    | AgentBench: Evaluating LLMs as Agents                                                                             | Verified                             | ICLR 2024; arXiv:2308.03688    |
| 4    | Toolformer: Language Models Can Teach Themselves to Use Tools                                                     | Verified; DOI correction recommended | NeurIPS 2023; arXiv:2302.04761 |
| 5    | Voyager: An Open-Ended Embodied Agent with Large Language Models                                                  | Verified                             | arXiv:2305.16291               |
| 6    | ReSpAct: Harmonizing Reasoning, Speaking, and Acting Towards Building Large Language Model-Based Social AI Agents | Verified                             | arXiv:2410.00071               |
| 7    | WebArena: A Realistic Web Environment for Building Autonomous Agents                                              | Verified                             | ICLR 2024                      |
| 8    | Mind2Web: Towards a Generalist Agent for the Web                                                                  | Verified                             | NeurIPS 2023                   |
| 9    | ToolLLM: Facilitating Large Language Models to Master 16,000+ Real-World APIs                                     | Verified                             | arXiv:2307.16789               |
| 10   | Tree of Thoughts: Deliberate Problem Solving with Large Language Models                                           | Verified                             | NeurIPS 2023; arXiv:2305.10601 |

## 4. Important Citation-Completeness Finding

The bibliography contains 10 references, but the paper body explicitly cites only [1], [2], and [3]. Therefore references 4–10 are currently uncited. This is a completeness problem rather than evidence of fabrication. Before submission, add in-text citations where these papers genuinely support statements, or remove unused entries from the bibliography.

## 5. Metadata Corrections Recommended

- **Toolformer:** the paper lists the arXiv DOI 10.48550/arXiv.2302.04761. The published NeurIPS 2023 version has DOI 10.52202/075280-2997; use the publication DOI if your required citation style prefers it.
- **Reflexion:** add the NeurIPS 2023 venue for consistency if using the conference version.

- **Voyager and ReSpAct:** retain the arXiv identifiers and, where required, state that the cited record is an arXiv preprint.
- **WebArena and Mind2Web:** keep persistent identifiers or official project links for reproducibility.

## 6. Claim-to-Source Integrity

The paper correctly states that citation verification has two dimensions: confirming that a source exists and confirming that the source actually supports the claim. A final claim-level audit should check the chain **Claim** → **Source** → **Evidence Passage** → **Interpretation** for all substantive claims, especially claims without [1]–[3] citations.

## 7. Final Verdict

**SUBSTANTIALLY VERIFIED — REVISION RECOMMENDED.**

The 10 bibliography entries are identifiable and no fabricated reference was detected in this audit. The most important correction is to reconcile the bibliography with the in-text citations. Standardizing publication metadata, especially the Toolformer DOI, will further improve citation integrity.

## 8. Verification Sources

<https://mlanthology.org/iclr/2023/yao2023iclr-react/>

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2303.11366>

[https://proceedings.iclr.cc/paper\\_files/paper/2024/hash/e9df36b21ff4ee211a8b71ee8b7e9f57-Abstract-Conference.html](https://proceedings.iclr.cc/paper_files/paper/2024/hash/e9df36b21ff4ee211a8b71ee8b7e9f57-Abstract-Conference.html)

[https://proceedings.neurips.cc/paper\\_files/paper/2023/hash/d842425e4bf79ba039352da0f658a906-Abstract-Conference.html](https://proceedings.neurips.cc/paper_files/paper/2023/hash/d842425e4bf79ba039352da0f658a906-Abstract-Conference.html)

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.16291>

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2411.00927>

[https://proceedings.iclr.cc/paper\\_files/paper/2024/hash/4410c0711e9154a7a2d26f9b3816d1ef-Abstract-Conference.html](https://proceedings.iclr.cc/paper_files/paper/2024/hash/4410c0711e9154a7a2d26f9b3816d1ef-Abstract-Conference.html)

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2306.06070>

<https://arxiv.org/abs/2307.16789>

[https://proceedings.neurips.cc/paper\\_files/paper/2023/hash/271db9922b8d1f4dd7aaef84ed5ac703-Abstract-Conference.html](https://proceedings.neurips.cc/paper_files/paper/2023/hash/271db9922b8d1f4dd7aaef84ed5ac703-Abstract-Conference.html)